

Praying in Tongues and Speaking Mysteries

We are studying the laws of meditation. Psalm 1:1:

Blessed is the man that walketh not in the counsel of the ungodly, nor standeth in the way of sinners, nor sitteth in the seat of the scornful. But his delight is in the law of the Lord; and in His law doth he meditate day and night.

If anybody knows my heart, God does. He knows if there is anything on His green earth that I want to be, it is a blessed man of God. I want to be blessed of God.

I do not care if any denomination puts its seal on me. I like them to like me. I do not care if the world or anybody else puts their seal on me. I like them to like me. What I really want to be is a blessed man of God. As long as I can say God is blessing me, I am happy if I am in prison. All I want to be is a blessed man of God.

If that is what I want to be, then what qualifies me? Number one, he walks not in the counsel of the ungodly. Number two, he does not stand in the way of sinners. Basically He is saying this: what qualifies me to be that blessed man of God is if I do not take my counsel from the world, if I do not do things the way sinners do, and if I do not sit in the seat of the scornful and in judgment.

If I am not going to take my counsel from the world, and if I refuse to do things the way sinners do, then I had better take this one step further.

The world has some good counsel. If you are not going to take your counsel from the Word of God, then you had better go get it from the world. They have some good doctors. The Catholic Church builds hospitals. Thank God for the relief of pain wherever you find it. I thank God for men who have dedicated their lives to that.

But it does not exclude the fact that there is a higher counsel. It does not exclude the fact that in eternity it has been settled that for this grace dispensation:

Himself took our infirmities, and bare our sicknesses.

If I can somehow find that counsel within my spirit, then I do not have to take the other.

To become that blessed man of God, if you do not take your counsel from the world and do not do things the way sinners do, then you had better take this one step further. That blessed man's delight was in the law of the Lord, in the Word of God, and in that Word that blessed man meditated day and night.

What was the sole purpose for his meditation? Again, it was not so I could quote more verses than you. The reason for the meditation was so that I could extract the counsel from the Word of God that I needed to walk by, so I did not have to do things the way the world does anymore.

If you are not going to take your counsel from the world, then you had better take that second step, whose delight is in the law of God. If you are not going to take that second step and delight yourself in His Word, then you had better stay with your present counsel.

Do you like me? Thank you.

In definition, what is meditation? Let me tell you what it is not. Meditation is not memorization, although it assists meditation. Meditation is not reading, although reading assists meditation. Meditation is not study, although study assists meditation.

The truest definition is this: meditation is when you finally learn how to allow the Holy Spirit to get involved with your spirit in such a way that He can take the counsel that left the heart of God in the form of the Word, and then reconstruct it in your heart in counsel and understanding that you and I can walk by.

That is the truest purpose and the truest form of meditation.

As you turn over to 1 Corinthians 14, let me remind you that the man who taught me how to meditate was an old logger by the name of Earl Hitchens. You have seen his kind if you have ever driven through a small logging town. They park their four-wheel rigs outside the bars, stand out there and talk with their foot on the running boards: big bright red suspenders, big dungaree lace-up shoes, bright plaid shirt, and a chainsaw in their back pocket.

That was Earl Hitchens. He was rough from the word go.

One time, Earl and his brothers were so mean that what they used to do was hot-rod in front of the police station just to get them to chase them. They enjoyed the chase. When the police caught them, threw them in jail overnight, and impounded their cars, they would sneak back in and steal their keys.

That is the kind of guy Earl was. He was so tough he whipped everybody in town. The town boys got together and imported a sergeant from the Marines who knew karate to come in and do Earl in. That is how bad he was.

That guy got Earl in a throat hold. Earl said he did not know what happened. "I was almost passed out. Just about out, just a foot from the ground, I regained consciousness. I gave him a right hook clear from the floor and put him out."

That is how tough he was. When I ran into Earl, thank God he was born again.

One time he was drinking in a bar and got in a fight with a guy. They said, "Do not do it in here." Earl said, "Let's go on out."

I am just giving you an idea.

Earl walked out in front of him. In the light of the streetlights, just as they stepped out of the bar, Earl saw something glisten at the corner of his eye. This guy had pulled a knife, run it around in front of him, and pulled straight back with it.

Earl said, "I turned sideways, and he just barely sliced my side."

I said, "What did you do?"

He said, "Well, first I knocked him out. Then when he came to, there was this big sludgy sewer out behind the bar. It was an open sewer, just horrible. They throw up in those places and flush it down."

I said, "What did you do?"

He said, "When he gained consciousness, every time he tried to get up, I just kicked him in the bottom until I kicked him over into the sewer. It was cold anyway."

The reason he told me that story is because later on they were having a fellowship, and who did they run into but this guy he had kicked into the sewer, and he was born again too.

That man said, "The hardest trial of my life was to forgive you."

You are beginning to understand the nature of Earl.

Earl was just as tough when somebody introduced him to the Word. This guy did not just have rough edges; he was a whole mountain range. He got turned on to the Word.

"Bless God, it works. Bless God, it works. That is all I will say about it. It works."

He preached it all over his logging camp. "It works." He preached it to those tobacco-chewing loggers. Their breath and tobacco were so strong, if they spit by your foot, they would eat a hole in the floor. They were tough. I know. I lived among them.

Earl Hitchens said, "Hey, Davey."

I said, "Yeah."

He said, "Did I ever tell you the story about the time I was logging with the worst old sinner boy in town? Just me and him. We were out falling. We always fell in twos; you never fall alone."

I said, "What happened, Earl?"

He said, "Do you know what a widow-maker is?"

I said, "A widow-maker?"

He said, "A widow-maker is a tree that grows up under tremendous pressure, but you do not know it until you cut through the butt of it with a chainsaw. A lot of times it will barber-chair. It will fly out under that pressure and swing around real hard. Generally, if you cut through one of them and get hit by it, it makes a widow out of your wife. That is why they call them widow-makers."

I said, "Oh, a widow-maker."

He said, "I got hit by one. My partner was over cutting, and I cut through it. That thing split out, barber-chaired, caught me, threw me, and broke my back. I landed on the ground and could not move. I was paralyzed white. I was going in and out of consciousness, lying on the ground."

He said, "By that time my partner looked over, saw it, and came running. Here I was, fading in and out of consciousness, wracked with pain in the upper part of my body. I could not move. I was passing out. My legs would not move."

With all the strength in him, he said, "Partner, you are not going to understand what I am about to do, but I do not have any choice. If I do not do it, I will die out here."

His partner said, "I will take you in."

Earl said, "There is not time. We are five miles from the road."

After Earl said that, he screamed in a loud voice, with all the strength he could muster:

"I am declaring before God the Father, Jesus Christ, and all the angels in heaven, that by His stripes I am healed. I am making that declaration before all the devils in hell. If the Word of God declares I am healed, I am healed, and I believe that I receive it this moment."

Earl said from that moment he quit passing out. He pulled himself to his knees and managed to pull himself to his feet. He took one step and passed out again from pain. His partner sat there watching this mess the whole time.

He said, "I believe that I receive."

He got up, passed out again, took five steps, passed out again, took fifteen steps, passed out again.

I told you, he was tough.

Finally, he managed to walk five miles out. The insurance company said, "You are not going to the hospital?"

He said, "No."

They said, "Then quit your job or waive your insurance and go back to work."

Earl was so wracked with pain lying in his bed that he could not even get out of bed, but the next morning he got his chainsaw and met his partner. That morning they were falling with the crew. Earl said it took everything he had to drag the chainsaw up the hill. They wanted to help him, but he would not let them.

When he got up there, the crew started cutting. They left him, falling one tree after another. He was left back there trying to cut one tree.

I said, "What happened?"

He said, "I would fire the chainsaw up and put it on the trunk of the tree, and it would just slide down, skinning bark. I would get in so much pain that I would have to step back. I would almost pass out. Then I would stop, and after I could, I would fire it up again and push it against the tree. All the time I was quoting the Word."

He did it not once, not twice, not three times, not four times, not five times, not six times. But the seventh time, he said, "I pulled that chainsaw up. I touched the tree with it. There was no bolt of lightning. There were no supernatural sensations. There was nothing. But all the pain in my body left instantly, and I ripped through that tree. I caught up with the crew, and from that day on, I outcut everybody. Even an old back injury I had was gone."

It was Earl Hitchens who slipped me my first Hagin tapes. When Earl found me, I was a young holiness boy preaching holiness standards. I did not know anything about the Word. We preached all kinds of stuff. We did not know much.

Earl found me and gave me a Hagin tape. I listened to that Hagin tape:

"When I was a young Baptist boy on the bed of affliction, God healed my body..."

I was used to people like David Terrell. If you ever heard David Terrell, he would leap from the platform, jump benches, spit cotton balls, kick your chair out from under you. Brother, he was a preaching machine. He would scream and holler, and that was my kind of man.

Hagin could have anything and stand in the washpan and preach, never moving. I got Hagin's tapes, and he bored me so badly the first quarter of the tape, monotone:

"Well, sir, well, sir, it was about 1948..."

I thought, "How could he have anything?"

I had just gone full time in the ministry, and three months later when our groceries and cupboards were empty and nothing I was doing was working, I dug his tapes back out and thought, "Maybe I had better listen to what the man has to say."

From that day forth, I found out I was righteous, and I began to write my own ticket with God.

Earl started really hanging around when I got turned on to the Word. I will never forget it. I would listen to some Hagin tapes, then go into the closet and pray in tongues, and pray in tongues, and pray in tongues. That is all I was doing: praying in tongues.

Sometimes when Earl was not busy, he would meet me down there in the morning and pray in tongues with me. I would get there at 6:30 in the morning and pray in tongues, then listen to some cassettes, then pray in tongues, then listen to some more Hagin, then pray in tongues.

Something started happening to me. Not only was I understanding all the Hagin stuff, but I started noticing that when I meditated the Word, verses I had read at least a thousand times as a young ultra-holiness boy, verses I used to think meant something entirely different and preached that way, started opening up.

We used to preach:

| We know that all things work together for good to them that love God.

"What things?"

"Car wrecks and diseases. That is good for you. God knows what you need."

We used to preach, "You are purified in the furnace of affliction. You ought to thank God if He takes you through cancer. Praise God if you endure to the end, right when they cover you up."

So I started meditating verses, and it even astonished Earl. Earl had heard everything they had and had stood on the Word for years, and it astonished Earl. I would open the Word of God and say, "Earl, have you ever seen this verse?" Then I would tell him what it meant.

He would look at me and say, "David, how in the world did you get that?"

I said, "Earl, do you not hear a little voice inside that explains it to you?"

"Not exactly, no."

I said, "Well, I do. I hear this little voice in there that told me what the verse meant. Is that not something?"

He said, "That beats anything I have ever seen."

I said, "It must be because I am called to preach. That is it. What would I preach if God did not talk to me? That explains it."

No, it does not. Have you ever heard lousy preachers? He does not just give it to you because you are a preacher. You have the Holy Ghost. You have the same option to understand the Word as we do.

We might have a teaching gift, which is simply the ability to transfer a revelation to your spirit. You might not do that too well. You may say, "I know what it means. I will tell you that."

"What does it mean?"

"Would you say that again?"

Then they say, "Come over here, teacher."

And he goes, "Oh, I see."

Thank God for a teaching gift. Thank God for a man who can put forth that kind of revelation knowledge.

I thought, "God, if it is not because I am called to preach, how come I hear this voice? How come I hear explanations for verses? I do not understand it."

God started telling me all kinds of things. It started setting me free. When He opened up to me why I was getting what I was getting, it opened up one of the most powerful walks of my entire ministry.

We have taken these truths and made victorious believers. We have made one preacher after another successful who was absolutely failing somewhere. We have caused singers who sing psalms in the world to become so powerfully anointed that suddenly they were in demand, just off this one revelation.

I kept bugging God. "How come I can hear? How come I am understanding revelation knowledge? How come it is coming to me? Why?"

When He explained why I was getting what I was getting, and I started putting forth that revelation, which is the first step to your meditations, from that day to this, I have been able to walk in these principles. There is nothing I can remember that I came before God wanting to understand with all my heart that He did not give me the understanding.

What we are about to tell you is the first number one major key.

Look at 1 Corinthians 14:1:

Follow after charity, and desire spiritual gifts, but rather that ye may prophesy. For he that speaketh in an unknown tongue speaketh not unto men, but unto God: for no man understandeth him; howbeit in the spirit he speaketh mysteries.

You say, "Roberson, what were you doing any different than a lot of your colleagues?" A lot of us boys started in faith together. What was I doing differently that caused me to hear revelation knowledge in my spirit?

He says, "Desire spiritual gifts, but rather that you may prophesy, for he that speaks in an unknown tongue speaks to God." In essence, he is saying prophecy speaks to men, but the tongue speaks to God.

He was not saying one gift was greater than the other. The thrust of this entire chapter is that you and I as believers should really seek to excel to a place in God where we edify the whole body of believers, to be used by God to edify you. In the light of that, he was saying that you needed to seek to be used in prophecy or interpretation of tongues, which equals prophecy.

He was not saying prophecy was greater. He was simply differentiating between the two here. He says, "You should excel to prophesy, for he that speaks in the unknown tongue, the man talks to God."

Prophecy is God talking to men. There is a difference.

He says:

He that speaketh in an unknown tongue speaketh not unto men, but unto God: for no man understandeth him.

If I were speaking in a tongue to be interpreted, then some interpreter, if not me, would understand it. But this particular tongue that you are talking to God in, he says, no man understands it. No man. Therefore, it is not tongues to be interpreted. It is tongues for personal edification.

"Roberson, was this what you were doing?"

Yes, it was. This is what I was doing that was different than most of the colleagues who surrounded me. But I never taught on it, because I naturally assumed that all of them were praying in tongues. I did not know that anybody was not.

I came from the middle of a holiness background. I worked so much I really did not have time to pray, but I naturally assumed that all my peers, elders, pastors, and preachers spent the majority of their day praying. I thought, "My God, what else would they do?"

Come to find out, that is why they build golf courses and country clubs.

You folks earn a good living. One man wants to be a scientist, another wants to be a pastor. Who else works Saturday preparing a little message, then comes out and talks to your little Sunday boy? That is some short hours, drawing your big fat paycheck. God forbid. I thought nobody would ever live like that.

So I thought everybody was doing it. I did not teach that you folks needed to pray in tongues because talking to God edifies you. I did not know what was edifying me in that realm. I was just doing it.

When the benefits from it began to come and I started understanding the Word, I thought, "Why is this coming on me?" We could not figure it out.

He says:

He that speaketh in an unknown tongue speaketh not unto men, but unto God: for no man understandeth him; howbeit in the spirit he speaketh mysteries.

Watch this. "Howbeit" at the end of the second verse is an analytical word. If I am not talking to men but talking to God, then how is this? Howbeit, I am speaking mysteries.

What am I speaking? Mysteries. I am actually speaking some kind of mystery unto God. I am in a supernatural language speaking mysteries, commonly known as divine secrets.

This bears passing in review from last year, when God finally began to bring me the revelation, as I call it, of the revelation: the revelation of why I was understanding revelation knowledge.

When I found out that in the Spirit, when I am praying in tongues, I am actually speaking divine secrets and mysteries, I saw that I am not talking to the devil. He does not understand what I am saying. This language is none of his business. It is not even really any of your business if it is not meant to be interpreted, because this is between me and my Father God.

He said I am speaking divine secrets between me and Him, past all powers and principalities, spiritual wickedness in heavenly places, princes and rulers of darkness, past all of them. My spirit is in direct communication with God Himself, speaking divine secrets and mysteries.

When I understood what God was trying to get over to me, you do not think I got my Greek interlinears, my outerlinears, my exteriors, my interiors, my Wuest, my Weeks, my Strong's, Greek and Arabic dictionaries, and anything else I could get my hands on to dissect the word mysteries?

If there is one thing you and I know about tongues, it is that he who speaks in an unknown tongue is building himself up on his most holy faith. He is actually edifying himself. Jude 20 says we are building ourselves up on our most holy faith by praying in the Holy Ghost.

We already know that praying in tongues affects our faith. We just did not know how it affects it. Faith really only comes one way. The Word of God is true. Faith comes by hearing and hearing by the Word of God.

First, I will preach the Word to you. Faith will come by hearing and hearing by the content which is in the Word. You may hear me preach the Word, but you might not hear the Word. Faith comes by hearing and hearing by the Word of God. Jesus said, "My words are spirit, and they are life." When you hear by the Word of God, you are hearing the life that is in it.

We know praying in tongues edifies us. The word mysteries was the key to all of this.

In that word mysteries, it breaks down to mean a divine secret on the inside of God, available to be transferred to your human spirit through the intermediary action of tongues. It is a divine secret, a mystery on the inside of God, which is available to be transferred to your spirit through the intermediary action of tongues.

I am speaking these divine secrets up before God. These mysteries pertain to the exact same mysteries that have been hidden in God since the foundations of the world, since before the world ever was, but have been made available to you and me, the Church, in this grace dispensation, through the Holy Spirit.

These mysteries which have been hidden in God have been made available to be transferred to your spirit, and they all pertain to Christ in you: the mystery of godliness, Christ in you, the hope of glory, Christ in you, through you, and to you.

Everything that pertains to Him in a mystery is what you are praying in tongues.

One day I asked God, "Why such a peculiar language? What a peculiar language, that we speak out of our spirit. What a method You have given us to extract these mysteries with. Why have You done this?"

The whole world looks at us and marks us as peculiar. So we go right along with it: "Yeah, we are peculiar." They mean weird, but that is not what peculiar means.

Peculiar means that when there is a plague in the land, we do not get it. Peculiar means that when trucks do not have food to haul into the city, we eat. Brother, that is peculiar. But that is not what they mean. The world looks at you as weird.

I said, "Lord, we do speak a weird language. It looks funny to the natural man out there."

It is like these two drunks who staggered by a Pentecostal church. They heard them speaking in tongues, and one of them said, "Let's get out of here. My mom told me that is the devil."

The other one looked at him and said, "If it was the devil, would we not do it?"

Psychologists have a field day with this.

"You all are good, sound people, all right, but you are a little overbalanced religiously. You need something that will satisfy your mind, that gives you some kind of release and satisfies you that God is with you somehow. You need that because you are slightly off-balance."

I kept asking God, "Lord, why tongues? Why did You choose this method to get revelation knowledge into our spirit?"

What He spoke to me I will never forget as long as I live. I was getting to think that God did not even know the answer.

He said, "Son, among My creation, among men, there has never been a language created that carries within itself the vocabulary to express everything that I am in you through Jesus Christ."

That language had to originate with God Himself. I am speaking divine secrets and mysteries pertaining to everything Christ is in me, the hope of glory, up before the throne room of grace.

And like any other prayer, this prayer is designed to be answered. That is why you are edified. It is designed to be answered.

When God answers the putting forth of these divine secrets out of my spirit, suddenly illumination is born on the inside of me. Some verse I have passed over a thousand times, a verse that has recorded the thoughts of God, eternity comes alive in me and produces mountain-moving, devil-stomping faith.

What are you going to do, pray in tongues more or something?

I heard that large sigh over here.

Why do you think Paul had the audacity to say, in writing to the entire Corinthian church, to every man, woman, and child, concerning the proper use of tongues, not the improper use, the proper use:

I thank my God, I speak with tongues more than ye all.

Speaking of Paul, let us talk about John G. Lake for a moment. How many have heard of John G. Lake? One of the most powerful healing ministries to come along in five hundred years. What a man of God.

In Africa, when the bubonic plague was killing people so badly they could not bury them any way but mass graves, he was over there as a missionary. John G. Lake was preaching, and he kept running around and not dying. The doctors were amazed. They wanted to make some kind of serum out of his blood or something.

They said, "You have a mysterious immunity."

He said, "You are right."

They said, "Do you mind if we experiment?"

They put a microscope over his hand, took one of the bubonic plague germs in the saliva of somebody who had died, smeared it on his hand, and watched it under the microscope. It died at contact.

They said, "Could you please explain this?"

He said, "Very simply. The law of the Spirit of life in Christ Jesus hath made me free from the law of sin and death."

He came back to the States and became one of the most powerful men who lived. One man who had the equivalent of the Baptist presidency over a great big northwest Bible college, over an entire Baptist move in Lake's day, wrote about John G. Lake:

"He is the nearest thing to Jesus Christ walking the earth I have ever seen."

The multitude strove to touch him because many of them went away whole in touch.

What a thing to be written about you.

I uncovered some unpublished, unedited notes of John G. Lake. All of a sudden, I am uncovering a page of one of the most powerful men of God who ever lived. I read this. He said:

"I want to speak to you with the utmost frankness and say to you that praying in tongues, that peculiar language, has been the making of my ministry."

He said that peculiar language he communicated to God in was the source of the messages he preached day by day.

I thought, "Roberson, you are right on and you are Tulsa on."

Paul said, "I thank my God that I speak in tongues more than you all." And yes, he was responsible for three quarters of the revelation knowledge, specifically in the areas of grace.

I could see the whole thing taking place. Paul going from one meeting to the next, riding along. His pilot was there, piloting along on his mule, horse, donkey, or however he traveled.

"Oh Paul, what did you say?"

"I am not talking to you."

He is communicating mysteries. Periodically, during the communication of these mysteries, God would answer. Paul would grab a quill, stick it in an inkwell, and by candlelight that night, when they were resting or in his jail cell, he would start recording that divine secret that just came alive in his spirit.

God took it and read it. God thought so much of it, He called them epistles and made them a permanent part of the Word of God.

Then you say, "Roberson, I am meditating the Word."

What are you after? You are after the same mysteries. You are after the same divine secrets. You are after what the Holy Ghost recorded there, not the doctrines of man.

When I am praying in tongues, I will do this: now that I know what He is doing, I will get on a chapter and meditate it. Then I will go off and pray in tongues for a couple of hours. I will get quiet and listen. Many times He will start feeding the mystery of it back through my spirit.

I go, "That is what that means?"

That is the same thing Paul got.

"Prove it."

We prove it later when the mountain moves.

What am I speaking? I am speaking the same revelation knowledge, the same mysteries recorded in the Word of God. Same mysteries.

When I pray them up before God and He answers them, can you see the powerfulness of the tool that praying in tongues is to your meditation?